

Indian Institute of Technology Delhi
CENTRAL RESEARCH FACILITY

Minutes of Meeting of Central Facility Committee (CFC) held on November 22, 2021 at 4 PM in an online mode.

Members present: Profs. Ashok Ganguli (DD S&P), S.G. Deshmukh (DDO), S.K. Khare (Dean, R&D), Sukumar Mishra (Associate Dean R&D), Pankaj Srivastava (Head, CRF), Ashwini Agrawal (Ex-Head, CRF), Sameer Sapra (Associate Head CRF), Rajesh Prasad, Monica Aggarwal, Tapan K. Nayak.

The Head CRF welcomed all members especially the newly inducted CFC members, Profs. Rajesh Prasad and Monica Aggarwal. He also acknowledged the contributions made by the outgoing members, Profs. Bhaskar Mitra and Suresh Neelkantan to the CRF activities.

The following issues were discussed:

(1) Introduction of Registration Fee and removal of payment through virtual money for usage of CRF facilities

Members were informed by the Head, CRF that it is becoming increasingly difficult to maintain various CRF facilities because of lack of funds. Therefore, a conscious effort is required to increase revenue generation of CRF. One step in this direction is to remove payment through virtual money for usage of CRF facilities by the internal users. The committee discussed this issue at length and following decisions were taken:

(i) From the next semester (starting from January 2022), there will be no transaction involving virtual money for the usage of CRF facilities. The virtual amounts accumulated so far will be zeroed. However, the amounts transferred by the users from their projects/other sources will be carried forward.

(ii) Every semester all internal users have to transfer real money to the CRF account. The proposed amounts are:

(a) Faculty, Group A Employees, Post Doctoral Fellows and Ph.D.: Minimum Rs. 2500/- (this will be equivalent to Rs. 5000/- i.e. the user will be able to carry out measurements amounting to Rs. 5000).

(b) M.Tech., M.Sc./B.Tech.: Minimum Rs. 1000/- (this will be equivalent to Rs. 2000/- i.e. the user will be able to carry out measurements amounting to Rs. 2000).

The users are free to deposit any amount equal to or more than mentioned in (a) and (b). They will be able to carry out measurements for double the amount deposited by them.

(iii) The proposed fee can be transferred from projects/student contingency grant/PDF/faculty seed grant.

(iv) If the usage exceeds the amounts mentioned in (a) and (b), the user will transfer more money as per his/her requirement to his/her account. The real component of unspent amounts will be carried forward to the next semester.

(v) The new system will be implemented from the next semester (January 2022).

(2) Opening of Premium Slots

It was decided that premium slots would be opened for selected facilities. These slots can be utilised by those users who require their measurements to be completed on an urgent basis. However, users have to pay double the price for the measurements. These slots would be scheduled off office hours or during the weekend so that they would not affect the normal operational hours.

(3) Removal of non-functional facilities from CRF

The Head CRF informed the members that some adopted central facilities viz. MALDI, FACS and ESI-MS are non-functional for quite some time despite providing funds as per the requests of their faculty

coordinators. It was decided that Head CRF would constitute a committee to look into this matter to decide whether to retain or remove these facilities from CRF.

(4) Procurement of Dilution Refrigerator and 400 MHz NMR

Head CRF informed the committee members that the procurement of Dilution Refrigerator was earlier approved by the CFC from HEFA grant. However, its procurement could not be materialised as the HEFA grant was put on hold. It is urgently required to complete the recently established Advance Electrical Characterization Laboratory under CRF. Also, the Director has approved the purchase of 400 MHz NMR as a central facility. The IRD has agreed to provide funds for both of these equipment. The CFC approved the procurement of Dilution Refrigerator and 400 MHz NMR as central facilities of the Institute.

(5) Policy regarding co-authorship to CRF employees of a research publication

The CFC members were informed that of late a number of Ph.D. qualified candidates have joined the CRF as employees. Some of them have inquired if they can be one of the co-authors in a research publication in which they had contributed significantly. The issue was discussed and the CFC opined that co-authorship of a CRF employee in any research publication would be decided by the user/faculty associated with the particular study. The CFC has no objection if a CRF employee becomes a co-author with the consent of the user/faculty.

(6) Framing policy for well performing CRF employees

It was decided to establish the employment structure of CRF on lines similar to IRD, GATE and JEE etc. for the benefit of CRF employees so that CRF can hire and retain good talent. This has become necessary as CRF now has a vast number of sophisticated machines that need to be run and maintained by highly qualified manpower. It was pointed out that without a clear policy in hiring (with respect to slabs, duration of contracts, promotions, and other employee benefits), good staff would continue to leave us and we would not be able to attract the right talent. The CFC was of the opinion that is the right time to formulate a policy in this regard. Both DD(O) and DD(S&P) supported this proposal. It was decided that a committee, including some members of the CFC would be formed to formulate a scheme suitable for CRF employees.

(7) Campus Housing for CRF employees

The CFC was informed that operational hours of several equipment have been increased. However, unavailability of housing for CRF employees in the campus is one of the bottlenecks in increasing the operational hours. The CFC decided to put a formal request to Institute authorities to consider providing housing facility for some employees of the CRF.

(8) Visibility of CRF on the Institute's web-site

Several CFC members pointed out that external users are finding it difficult to locate CRF web page on the Institute's web-site. It was decided to discuss this matter with web-site administrators.

The meeting ended with vote of thanks to the Chair.

(Ashok Ganguli)
Chairman, CFC & DD(S&P)


(Pankaj Srivastava)
Head CRF



Director (For Approval)
All CFC Members


4/12/2024

✓
Head, CRF